deemed to have failed. In other words, a minion hadn't put the plug in. Smithy was laughing all the way to the run bank.

Leadership has a wider social significance in South African sport, so the job is never easy. Hashim Amla considered giving up the captaincy when we won the first Test in Durban by 241 runs and stepped down after batting for 707 minutes in scoring 201 in the drawn second Test at Newlands in Cape Town, which is one of my favourite places to play cricket.

He was succeeded by AB de Villiers, whom I had known since we were kids, making our way in the Under-19s. I even got him out once, with a speciality delivery that rolled along the floor and hit him on the toe. We kept in touch as our careers progressed. He gave up wicketkeeping on becoming Test captain and could probably have done without us winning in Johannesburg, to take the series, in his first match.

Broady was a force of nature in their second innings, taking five wickets while conceding a solitary run in thirty-one deliveries as we bowled them out for 83. James Taylor, at short leg, took two miraculous catches, but attention was rightly seized by a definitive personal performance, a showcase for one man's skill, physical fortitude and sheer bloody-mindedness.

There was a lot of talk at the time about rationalizing the workload of bowlers like Broady and Jimmy. They were doing huge mileage and placing great strain on their bodies. At first, I simply could not believe the statistics. If we spent a long time in the field, they could be doing up to thirty kilometres a day, running in on unyielding ground, in temperatures of 35 degrees. Something like four times their bodyweight would go through their knees and ankles, six times in relatively quick succession, on a regular basis. Little wonder that, given the application of such forces, Jimmy had his back issues. The hardest thing about dealing with Broady was trying to change his mind. He took advice as if he was being asked to drink curdled milk.

I obviously played an awful lot of cricket with them both. The mind games worked out evenly. As captain, I had to balance their comfort zones with my wider views and responsibilities. Ultimately, as the ones delivering the ball, they knew what they wanted to do. Occasionally, that didn't involve factoring in what I wanted them to do.

The captain has the final say when a bowler asks for a field change but must calculate the degree of dissatisfaction disagreement will cause.